young people, that have been conducted over a decade regarding the changing Pakistani state.

Structure of the book

Chapter 1 discusses Pakistani youth's view on the social contract. Social contract theory posits that citizens and the state have an interdependent relationship with each other based on rights and responsibilities including the duty of political participation. This chapter questions how much this Western framework, which has underpinned Pakistan's postcolonial governments, is still relevant today. It further highlights how the social contract has increasingly been drawn into the security agenda with the NCEPG 2018 recognizing the importance of strengthening the state–citizen relationship through the delivery of basic services for the purposes of countering extremism at the community level. Many Pakistanis still feel the state ought to provide for their basic needs, especially with regard to employment. However, neither state nor government have delivered, resulting in civil society having to fend for itself. Since 2009, in light of growing numbers of terrorist attacks, the democratic state has increasingly turned into a security state – the rights of the citizens are protected on the condition that they do not challenge the writ of the 'security' state. The chapter explores the nature of this social contract, and young peoples' opinions about this state–citizen relationship.

Chapter 2 focuses on the nature of political activism among the youth. With the exception of ethno-nationalist movements that have support among young people from these ethnicities, political activism among students in educational institutions has gradually eroded over the past few decades. The chapter begins with an exploration of the historically located student activist and their role in the Pakistan movement, followed by an evaluation of the place of the student activist in the newly independent Pakistan. The first part focuses on important events linked to student activism on university campuses and their impact on larger provincial and national politics, highlighting a complex relationship of patronage as well as resistance between the state and its student activists. In contextualizing these narratives, the increasing use of violence by student groups within universities and the selective ban on union activities across the years is also explored, providing a context for the narratives of participants who are not members of such organizations. The chapter further highlights a problem with an understanding of political activism and what it means, as narratives of political awareness reveal the issue of political illiteracy among